

How many jobs can you reach by transit in the Twin Cities?

A scaled-down replication of the Accessibility Observatory's Access Across America transit method, built to learn it. Not original research.
Chinmay Arora · 7-county Metropolitan Council region · 2,535 block groups · LODES 2023 jobs · Metro Transit GTFS, Wed 7 Oct 2026, 7-9 AM

Map · Jobs reachable within 45 minutes by transit, by block group

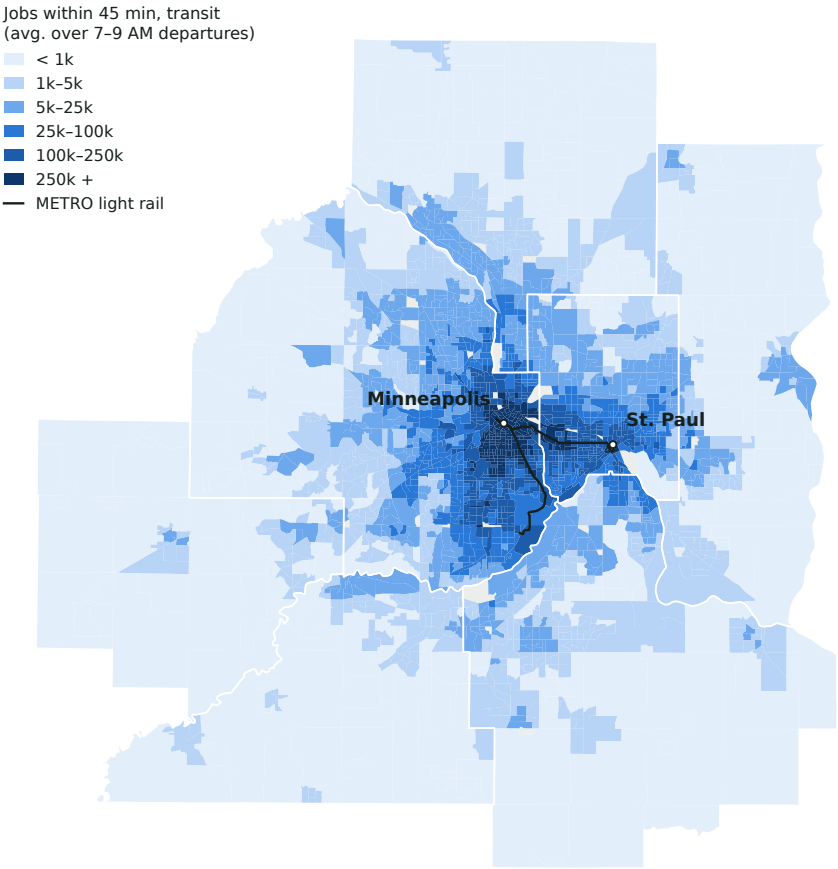
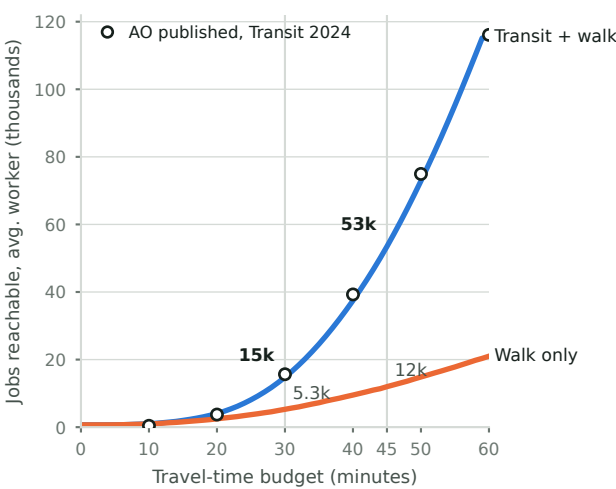


Chart · Jobs reachable by the average worker



Three findings

1 Transit multiplies reach, but from a small base.

The average worker can reach 14,785 jobs within 30 minutes by transit and 53,475 within 45, about 2.8x and 4.5x what walking alone reaches. Even at 45 minutes that is 3.0% of the region's 1.79 million jobs.

2 The gain is concentrated in the two core counties.

Hennepin and Ramsey workers reach 27,861 and 18,342 jobs in 30 minutes by transit. In the five other counties the figure is 1,720, against 1,347 on foot. For 70% of all workers, transit does not even double their 30-minute walking reach.

3 Departure minute matters, not just location.

For the median block group, 45-minute transit access swings by 56% of its average between the best and worst departure minute in 7-9 AM. That is service frequency showing up in the numbers, which is why AO averages every minute instead of picking one.

Methods and limits

What matches AO

Measure

Cumulative opportunities: jobs reachable within t minutes, averaged over every departure minute 7:00-8:59 AM (120 routed departures), then weighted by the workers living in each origin (AO's worker-weighted accessibility).

Routing

r5py (the R5 engine AO also uses) on OpenStreetMap + Metro Transit GTFS. Walk 3.6 km/h for access, egress and transfers; unlimited transfers; a walk-only trip counts as a transit trip if faster, as in AO.

Data

Jobs: LEHD LODS8 2023 WAC. Workers: LODS8 RAC. Geography: 2020 TIGER blocks rolled up to block groups; origin and destination points are worker- and job-weighted block centroids, not polygon centroids.

Check

Against AO's published Transit 2024 Twin Cities figures (chart, open circles): 14,785 vs 15,664 at 30 min, and within 6% at every threshold from 30 to 60 min. The differences below partly offset each other, so read this as a sanity check, not a validation.

Open question

AO's Transit 2024 abstract describes the 15% fastest travel times; its body describes an average over 7-9 AM. This run uses the average. Which one produces the headline figures?

Where this differs, and what it cannot say

Coarser zones

AO routes from every Census block; this uses 2,535 block groups. Jobs inside a worker's own block group count as a few minutes away, so the 10- and 20-minute values run high (about 2.5x AO at 10 min). Read 30 and 45 min, not below.

Smaller region

Seven counties, not AO's 16-county CBSA (which includes two Wisconsin counties). Jobs just outside the boundary are invisible, which understates access near the edge.

Walk access only

Like AO, nobody drives to a stop. SouthWest Transit's park-and-ride expresses are in the feed but add nothing to Carver County at 45 min. MVTA is not in the feed, so Scott shows no transit gain at all and Dakota is understated.

Schedules, not reality

Perfect on-time running, one fall 2026 Wednesday. LODS counts jobs where they are registered, and it cannot see remote work.

Aggregation test

Walking re-run to 19,148 block-level job points: block-group destinations shift 30-min access by +3.5% and 45-min by +1.4%.